

Northern Community Hub



Client



Handbook



VincentCare
Engage. Enable. Empower.



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Welcome

Welcome to VincentCare. This handbook has been developed to provide some important information you'll need while we are working with you. We want to make sure you feel safe, that your privacy is protected and that you

know your rights and responsibilities. This handbook tells you how to give us feedback or make a complaint – and what happens if you leave, but need our support again later. If you have any questions, please talk to a member of staff.

About VincentCare

VincentCare is a not for profit company established in 2003 by the Society of St Vincent de Paul in Victoria.

VincentCare's objectives are to provide responsive and high quality accommodation and support services for people experiencing homelessness and disadvantage, build meaningful partnerships with people, and create opportunities for personal recovery and sustained independence.

VincentCare has a broad range of services and programs to help support you including:

- Crisis Supported Accommodation
- Case Management Support
- Initial Assessment and Planning
- Tenancy and Property Management
- Young Adults Support

- Home Care Packages (for older adults)
- Disability Employment
- Allied Health services (e.g. Podiatry, Physiotherapy, Occupational Therapy)
- Emergency Relief & Financial Counselling
- Family Violence
- Alcohol and other Drug Treatment services
- Post-detox Supported Accommodation
- Homelessness Early Intervention and Prevention
- Private rental head leasing
- Drop-in support and material assistance for people sleeping rough
- Community Rooming House
- Client Volunteer and Peer Support
- Planned Activity Groups
- Private Rental Brokerage

And if we can't help you, we can refer you to another service that can.



Our aspiration

To be a leader in providing, care hope and advocacy for those facing disadvantage.



Our motto

Engage.
Enable.
Empower.



Our purpose

To create opportunities and lasting change for the most marginalised.



Our values

Accountability
Courage, Compassion,
Dignity, Excellence,
Leadership.



Your **safety**

Your safety, and the safety of other clients, staff and volunteers is more than important – it is essential. Your safety includes physical, psychological and cultural safety.

We want you to feel safe and supported to be who you are, whatever your identity. We call this ‘cultural safety’ and it’s especially important if you are from the LGBTIQ community, if you speak languages other than English, or are Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander.

Please let us know immediately if:

- You are threatened or feel intimidated by anyone.
- Someone makes a racist, sexist, homophobic or transphobic comment, to you or someone else.
- You feel vulnerable or unsafe in any way.



Your rights and **responsibilities**

At VincentCare you have the right to:

- Feel physically and culturally safe
- Be treated with dignity and respect
- Have your privacy protected
- Make your own choices
- Receive support free of discrimination and judgment
- Make a complaint or appeal a decision
- Participate in the decision making process of the organisation
- Assistance during a crisis or to prevent a crisis
- Receive help finding and staying in suitable housing on a long-term basis
- Receive help in applying for income support, employment and health services, educational opportunities and other support services
- Have information provided to you in a language you understand

You also have the responsibility to:

- Supply accurate, up-to-date and truthful information
- Meet your responsibilities as a resident or client
- Respect other people’s privacy
- Respect every individual regardless of their cultural background, ability, ethnicity, gender identity, sexual orientation or religion

If you believe that your rights have not been upheld, or you disagree with a decision that we’ve made, please let us know so we can attempt to resolve the issue.

If you are still not satisfied after that, you can make an official complaint (please see the ‘Complaints’ section in this handbook).



Your **privacy**

VincentCare is committed to ensuring that the collection, use and storage of personal information is undertaken in accordance with the relevant legislation and community sector standards.

To ensure you are aware of what is happening to your personal information, a worker will talk to you about your privacy and ask that you sign a Consent to Release Information Form. This allows VincentCare to exchange your personal information with other agencies where it is relevant to your housing and support needs.

You have the right to cancel or withdraw your consent at any time. This can be undertaken verbally or in writing. If you chose to cancel or withdraw your consent in writing you will need to sign and date a form that will be provided to you by VincentCare. If you wish to cancel or withdraw your consent verbally you simply need to contact a staff member and let them know.

It will then be noted in your client record that you no longer give consent for VincentCare to exchange your personal information.



How to access your **information**

You have the right to access information about yourself that VincentCare has collected.

You can ask to add, edit or delete any of your personal information at any time. If you wish to access the information VincentCare has collected about you, please complete the Client Access to Information Form that will be provided to you upon request. Staff can help you to complete the form if required.

Once we've received your request, we are required by law to get back to you within 45 days. We will, however, aim to get back to you within 10 business days.

Access to your personal information may take the form of:

- A copy of your client record or file
- An appointment to view your client record or file
- An appointment with a staff member to discuss your client record or file

There are some situations where access to your client record or file may be restricted or refused. For example, if doing so affects the privacy or safety of other people.

Contact us

For further information or assistance, please contact:

Office of the Victorian Information Commissioner

Freecall: 1300 666 444

Email: privacy@cdpd.vic.gov.au



How to make a **complaint**

If you are unhappy with a service that is being provided, or was provided to you, or you wish to appeal a decision we've made, please let us know. This includes where services or support have been withdrawn from you.

You have the right to make a complaint at any time.

Making a complaint will not negatively influence the service you receive from VincentCare either now or in the future. The most important thing is that you let us know. This allows us to fix the issue for you, and gives us important feedback on how to improve our services.

Step 1	Where possible, please discuss your complaint with your case manager, support worker or a member of staff. It may be possible to resolve the issue without taking it further.
	If this is not possible, please complete a VincentCare Client Complaint Form. You can find them on the front counter of our offices. You can request an envelope to ensure privacy and submit your complaint to the Team Leader or Coordinator of your service.
	It is your right to remain anonymous, however if you would like staff to follow up with you personally, please provide your name and contact details.
Step 2	If you provide your contact details, the Team Leader, Coordinator or Manager will make a time to meet with you and discuss your complaint.
Step 3	If you are not satisfied with the outcome, you can then raise the complaint or appeal the decision with the Hub Manager.
Step 4	If you are not satisfied with the outcome, you then have the right to raise the complaint or appeal the decision with the CEO.

At any stage in the process, you have the right to raise the matter with external bodies, including relevant government departments such as:

Homelessness Advocacy Service (HAS)
Freecall: 1800 066 256
Aged Care Complaints Commissioner
Freecall: 1800 951 822

How to make a suggestion or provide other **feedback**

As a client of VincentCare, we are always interested in feedback – what we did well, and what we could do better. There are a number of ways for you to provide feedback.

- Speak to a staff member directly
- Send an email to clientvoice@vincentcare.org.au
- Leave a comment or suggestion in

the Suggestion Box at reception.

- Complete an Exit Survey at the end of your service

Some VincentCare sites run “Have your Say” meetings; please speak to staff for details. VincentCare also runs a Client Advisory Committee where previous and current clients meet to provide advice and feedback on our policies, practices and performance. Again, please speak to staff if you are interested.

How to access support again if you leave

If you leave our service and require help again in the future, please contact us. There is no limit to the number of times we can support you.

If there is a member of staff you know well you may want to contact them directly, but any of our staff can help.

VincentCare Hubs

Inner Melbourne Community Hub
179-191 Flemington Rd, North Melbourne
Ph: 8327 7500

Northern Community Hub
175 Glenroy Rd, Glenroy
Ph: 9304 0100

Hume Community Hub
144 Welsford St, Shepparton
Ph: 5831 1840

Home Care Packages (Statewide)
Metropolitan Melbourne
Ph: 03 9321 2912

Hume and Lower Hume
Ph: 03 5831 1840

Seniors' Living Hub
2-6 Albert St, Blackburn
Ph: 9878 1051



VincentCare is committed to the principles of social justice and aims to ensure that every individual is treated with dignity and respect regardless of their ability, cultural background, ethnicity, gender identity, sexual orientation or religion.



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